

France — Student Visa & Study Abroad Guide

Updated: September 2026

Important: This is general educational information, not legal, immigration or financial advice. Visa rules, fees, financial thresholds, processing times and document requirements can change. Always verify the current official authority and institution requirements before applying.

Official immigration resources

Visa guidance: <https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/student>

Immigration / study information: <https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/student>

At a glance

Visa / route	Long-stay student visa / relevant student residence pathway
Common intakes	September is the main academic start; some programmes offer spring starts.

Typical student visa pathway

1. Select an eligible programme and confirm the admission route.
2. Complete Campus France / Études en France steps where applicable to your nationality and programme.
3. Obtain admission evidence from the institution.
4. Complete the France-Visas application and prepare the requested supporting documents.
5. Attend any required appointment, interview or biometric step and follow the instructions for arrival/residence formalities.

Common supporting documents

- Passport
- Admission/pre-enrolment evidence
- Proof of financial means as required
- Accommodation information where requested
- Proof of health/insurance where applicable
- Academic certificates/transcripts
- Campus France evidence where applicable

France: planning your study application

Admission and visa are separate decisions

A university offer does not by itself guarantee a visa. First confirm the exact programme admission conditions and deadline; then follow the current immigration route and evidence requirements for your nationality and circumstances.

Study planning checklist

- Check whether the programme is taught in French, English or both.
- Review Campus France and institution-specific deadlines.
- Compare tuition structures for public institutions and private schools.

After arrival

- Complete institution registration and any required local residence process.
- Keep copies of visa and enrolment documents.
- Check student work and residence conditions from the current official guidance.
- Follow university and local administrative deadlines.

Before submitting your visa application

- Check passport validity and identity details.
- Use the latest official application form/process for your country of residence.
- Make sure names, dates and education history are consistent across documents.
- Keep copies of submitted forms, receipts, appointment confirmations and supporting evidence.
- Check whether documents need certified translation and whether originals must be presented.
- Review the exact visa conditions after grant before travelling.

Useful official links

- [Official visa guidance](https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/student) — <https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/student>
- [Official immigration/study information](https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/student) — <https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/student>

ViaSphere counsellor checklist

Use this page as a preparation worksheet. The exact evidence depends on the student, programme, nationality and current rules.

Area	Check	Status
Course	Programme, duration, level and campus confirmed	■
University	Official programme/admissions page reviewed	■
English test	Accepted test and minimum section/overall scores checked	■
Academic documents	Transcripts/certificates and translations checked	■
Funds	Current official financial evidence requirements checked	■
Passport	Validity and personal details checked	■
Accommodation	Plan/evidence prepared if required	■
Insurance/health	Current requirement checked	■
Visa application	Current official route and forms checked	■
Arrival	Registration/orientation/travel plan prepared	■

Official-source rule

If this guide conflicts with an official immigration authority, embassy/consulate, university or testing-provider page, follow the current official source. ViaSphere should not be treated as the issuing authority for any visa or admission decision.